Westbrook Planning Board

~ Planning Board Meeting ~

Date: Tuesday, May 5, 2026
Time: 7:00 PM
Location: Westbrook High School (Room 114), 125 Stroudwater St. (Hybrid via Zoom)
Video: https://vimeo.com/1189559444
Packet: https://www.westbrookmaine.gov/AgendaCenter/ViewFile/Agenda/_05052026-1001

Timestamps below are clickable [0:00]-style links — they jump straight to that moment in the video.

This summary highlights the meeting's key discussions and decisions, with direct quotes and timestamps for verification — it is not a substitute for watching the full meeting. *This was an unusually long meeting (3.5 hours) with six scheduled items and heavy public turnout; summarization necessarily condenses and selects more than usual. For complete context, nuance, and anything not covered here, watch the full video at the link above. (Produced by: WestbrookCurrents.com)*

Unofficial summary. *This is produced by Westbrook Currents, an independent site — not the City of Westbrook — and may contain mistakes. For the official record, see the City's approved minutes and the meeting video.*

I. Roll Call

Roll Call, Minutes & Agenda Change [7:22]

Discussion Summary

Chair Larry McWilliams announced that the applicant for 160 Conant St. (NextGen Holdings) requested removal from tonight's agenda; it was not reviewed. Roll call: six of nine seated members present (McWilliams, Oriana Farnham, Robin Tannenbaum, Nancy Litrocapes, Vice Chair John Turcotte, and Karen Axelson); Lucas Schrage, Kevin Price, and Jason Frazier absent.

Key Decisions

✓ Minutes of the April 7, 2026 meeting approved by roll call, 6–0.

Action Items

None.

Workshop — Stroudwater Meadows (24-001219)

[9:52] Tuck O'Brien (incoming JB Brown & Sons president), Caleb Barassa (Gorrill Palmer), and Tyler Norad (Westbrook Development Corporation) presented a substantially revised concept: 322 units of mixed market-rate and income-restricted housing, down from an original roughly 740-unit concept shown to the board in December 2024, now clustered near Stroudwater Street per board and staff feedback. Roughly half of Westbrook households would income-qualify for the affordable-phase units, planned as family (not senior) housing at 50–60% of area median income.

Point/Counterpoint — arterial access vs. Stroudwater Street. Nearly every one of roughly fourteen public speakers raised traffic concerns and asked for direct vehicle access to the nearby arterial highway instead of routing all project traffic onto Stroudwater Street.

> *“The traffic has been substantially increased... adding this development where you have 300 units... most of them will be coming down our street again.”*

— Fred Fowler, Westbrook St., Portland (public comment) [31:22]

> *“Please don't have vehicle access to Stroudwater Street... Why can't there be a pedestrian overpass like there is on Lawrence Street for kids at Rock Row?”*

— Jane Cody, 19 Laughing Drive (public comment) [33:06]

Abutting Randall Farm advocates (a letter read on behalf of owner Mr. Randall, and Maine Farm Bureau President David Kent) separately asked for a permanent fence and vegetative buffer to protect the working cattle farm from tenant complaints about normal farm noise and odors, citing Maine's right-to-farm law.

[1:02:55] City Planner Rebecca Spitella explained the arterial is a freeway-type roadway where an at-grade pedestrian crossing isn't permitted under DOT standards; a grade-separated crossing was examined in an earlier design but proved cost-prohibitive. Stroudwater Street's capacity and mitigation options (including a possible roundabout at the middle-school intersection) are under review as part of the traffic movement permit process. The proposal's density and building types are already permitted under current zoning.

Vice Chair John Turcotte [1:14:59] pressed for an updated traffic study reflecting actual school traffic patterns and questioned whether the largest building, sited closest to Stroudwater Street, should move toward the rear with smaller buildings up front; member Robin Tannenbaum agreed and urged a more contextual, pitched-roof architectural style. Chair McWilliams [1:40:28] asked to see traffic projections for both the 322-unit plan and the original larger concept, concerned the reduced plan is a first phase of further buildup since roughly half the parcel remains undeveloped; staff and the applicant confirmed no future development is currently planned there but could not rule it out long-term. Member Oriana Farnham [1:24:40] asked that affordable units not be clustered separately from market-rate units for equitable amenity access.

Key Decisions

No vote — workshop item. The applicant anticipates returning with a formal application in summer 2026 after state Site Law and traffic-permit submissions.

Workshop — Bridgton Rd., Wormell Farms LLC (26-000123)

109-Unit Multifamily — Third Phase of the Former Wormell Farm [1:48:34]

Discussion Summary

Matthew Pelletier (Terradyn Consultants) presented 109 units across eleven two-and-a-half-story buildings on a ~60-acre parcel between 197 and 299 Bridgton Road — the third phase of a larger former farm property (following an existing 18-unit duplex complex and the in-progress 118-unit Brooks Edge Farm). Roughly 52 of the 60 acres, including extensive Minnow Brook wetlands, would remain permanently open space.

Neighboring residents raised concerns about a building sited only about 15 feet from a property line, light pollution, and — most substantively — longstanding road-runoff flooding tied to the 2006 state repaving of Route 302, which abutters said already funnels stormwater onto their properties and which they fear this project's new curbing will worsen; staff acknowledged this drainage history requires follow-up research with the City Engineer. Board members Oriana Farnham and John Turcotte raised headlight-glare concerns from parking facing directly into abutting backyards; Chair McWilliams suggested reorienting one building to reduce a sightline into a neighboring yard. Several board members, a recurring theme tonight, asked whether the City

could develop a cumulative, city-wide traffic framework rather than evaluating each large development in isolation; staff noted that question falls to City Engineering/Council rather than the board's project-by-project review.

Key Decisions

✓ No vote — workshop item.

Action Items

None.

Workshop — 547 Saco St., MTR Development LLC (26-000275)

72 Units, Six Buildings — New Ownership of a Former Farm Property [2:47:29]

Discussion Summary

Dustin Roma (DM Roma Consulting Engineers), representing new owner MTR Development, presented 72 units across six 12-unit buildings on a former farm property, with the existing farmhouse split onto its own lot and a barn retained for storage. The buildings are proposed at two and a half stories with pitched roofs and dormers, a deliberately different style from boxier recent construction, and the project would extend the City's sidewalk network toward El Maple along Saco Street. The applicant anticipates phased construction (roughly two buildings per year) and flagged time pressure from Saco Street's scheduled repaving this year.

Neighbors raised concerns that two buildings are sited close to a property line abutting a home with a pool, that density/height/parking are all at or near the zoning maximum with no dedicated visitor parking identified, and that the wetland delineation underlying the 72-unit count isn't yet finalized. Staff clarified site plan review proceeds in two stages (this conceptual sketch plan, followed by a detailed final application including wetland surveys, stormwater design, and a required performance bond) and that the zoning ordinance sets an objective development standard the board applies rather than a discretionary housing-type policy choice. Board members Nancy Litrocapes and Robin Tannenbaum praised the pitched-roof architectural style as more contextual than typical flat-roofed apartment buildings, while asking the applicant to pull the two buildings nearest the pool-owning neighbor's property line further back by straightening the site's curved driveway; the applicant agreed to study that change.

Key Decisions

✓ No vote — workshop item.

Action Items

None.

Items Not Reached

Rock Row South Campus Building SG & SR; Land Use Ordinance Height Amendment [2:49:31]

Discussion Summary

With the meeting running well past 10 PM after three lengthy workshop items, the board could not also hear the Rock Row South Campus Building SG & SR site plan (the 267-unit/parking-garage building previewed at the April 7, 2026 Rock Row Phase 3 master-plan workshop) or a Land Use Ordinance amendment removing the

2.5-story height limit in Residential Growth Area 2 and 3 (while retaining the existing 35-foot maximum height). With several members unavailable for the originally-proposed May 19 makeup date, staff indicated both items would likely be rescheduled to the board's June 2, 2026 meeting.

Key Decisions

✓ Deferred — no discussion held.

Action Items

None.

How this was made

This summary was produced from the meeting video (linked above, hosted on the City's Vimeo showcase). The audio was transcribed with AI-assisted speech-to-text and speaker identification. This process cross-checked names against the official Planning Board roster, attributed speakers from context (introductions, roll-call order, direct address by the Chair) rather than the raw diarization labels alone, and drafted this summary and the quoted excerpts. Quotes are lightly cleaned of filler words/false starts but not reworded. Review tier: Not reviewed.

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